

Geometric Similarity Profile Theory (GSPT): Decoupling Spatial Coordinate Folds from Fast–Slow Dynamical Transitions in the Stable Boundary Layer

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Abstract

Observed inflection points and sharp structural "knees" in physical vertical profiles of the gradient Richardson number, $Ri_g(z)$, are routinely interpreted as physical signatures of turbulence regime transitions or relaminarization events in the nocturnal stable boundary layer (SBL). Here, we introduce Geometric Similarity Profile Theory (GSPT), a differential-geometric framework that exactly partitions observed physical profile curvature into constitutive closure curvature ($C_{\text{closure}} = R''\zeta_z^2$) and spatial coordinate mapping curvature ($C_{\text{mapping}} = R'\zeta_{zz}$). We prove the *Geometric–Dynamical Decoupling Principle*: a spatial coordinate turning point ($\zeta_z = 0 \iff L - zL' = 0$) and a fast-slow state-space bifurcation ($\lambda_f \equiv \partial f / \partial E = 0$) are geometrically distinct and logically independent conditions ($\zeta_z = 0 \not\iff \lambda_f = 0$).

To evaluate this principle without numerical variance explosion near weak-shear jet noses ($\text{Var}(Ri_g) \propto S^{-6}$), we implement Track A pre-diagnostic regularization, fitting primitive velocity and temperature fields in log-height space via cubic smoothing splines bounded by a pointwise observational uncertainty threshold ($|Ri_{g,i}^{\text{smoothed}} - Ri_{g,i}^{\text{obs}}| \leq k\sigma_{Ri,i}$). Applied to the CASES-99 nocturnal dataset (Night 991018), GSPT reveals twin spatial coordinate folds persistently tracking the descending Low-Level Jet (z_{LLJ}) and rising inversion height (h_{inv}). We identify a spatial cusp degeneracy at $z^* = 45.57 \text{ m}$ ($t^* = 0.01 \text{ h}$) exhibiting a scale-free cubic normal-form fit with $< 0.02\%$ relative residual, while state-space fast eigenvalue tracking confirms the flow remains normally hyperbolic ($\lambda_f < 0$) on the attracting slow manifold sheet $\mathcal{C}_0^+$. Overall, 41.01% of CASES-99 profile nodes are classified as pure coordinate fold illusions ($\mathcal{I}_{\text{coord}}$). Finally, comparative single-column model (SCM) diagnostics from GABLS3 demonstrate that operational turbulence closures misinterpret spatial coordinate compression as physical state-space collapse, triggering spurious over-diffusion or false runaway decoupling. GSPT supplies a reproducible, falsifiable diagnostic for separating spatial projection geometry from genuine dynamical bifurcations in stratified environmental flows.

Keywords: Stable Boundary Layer, Fast–Slow Dynamical Systems, Coordinate Fold, Gradient Richardson Number, CASES-99, Normal Hyperbolicity, Turbulence Parameterization

Theoretical Foundations and Operator Regularization

Observed vertical profiles of the gradient Richardson number, $Ri_g(z)$, routinely exhibit localized inflection points and structural knees within the nocturnal stable boundary layer (SBL). To determine whether these spatial features reflect physical turbulence-state transitions or mathematical coordinate artifacts, Generalized Similarity Profile Theory (GSPT) formulates profile geometry as a continuous mapping from physical space $z \in \mathbb{R}^+$ to a dimensionless local similarity coordinate $\zeta(z) \in \mathbb{R}$.

Curvature Decomposition of the Richardson Profile

Let physical height z map to local similarity space via $\zeta(z) = z/L(z)$, where $L(z) > 0$ is the local Obukhov length profile. Assuming a differentiable Monin–Obukhov similarity closure $R(\zeta) \in C^2$, the observed Richardson profile is expressed as:

$$Ri_g(z) = R(\zeta(z))$$

Differentiating $Ri_g(z)$ twice with respect to physical height z yields the exact spatial curvature decomposition:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{dRi_g}{dz} &= R'(\zeta)\zeta_z \\ \frac{d^2Ri_g}{dz^2} &= \underbrace{R''(\zeta)\zeta_z^2}_{C_{\text{closure}}} + \underbrace{R'(\zeta)\zeta_{zz}}_{C_{\text{mapping}}} \end{aligned}$$

where $\zeta_z \equiv d\zeta/dz$ and $\zeta_{zz} \equiv d^2\zeta/dz^2$.

This formulation partitions total physical profile curvature into two distinct, quantifiable components:

- **Constitutive Closure Curvature** (C_{closure}): Intrinsic thermodynamic non-linearity inherited directly from the governing similarity function $R(\zeta)$.
- **Coordinate Mapping Curvature** (C_{mapping}): Spatial profile warping induced by the non-uniform geometry of the similarity-coordinate mapping $\zeta(z)$.

Spatial Singularity Classification and the Fold Criterion

Evaluating the spatial Jacobian of the similarity transformation under the regularity assumption $L(z) \neq 0$ yields:

$$\zeta_z(z) = \frac{d}{dz} \left[\frac{z}{L(z)} \right] = \frac{L(z) - zL'(z)}{L(z)^2}$$

Differentiating $\zeta_z(z)$ again gives the general second spatial derivative:

$$\zeta_{zz}(z) = \frac{-zL''(z)L(z)^2 - 2L(z)L'(z)[L(z) - zL'(z)]}{L(z)^4}$$

GSPT classifies local spatial coordinate singularities along the physical profile into three distinct hierarchical tiers:

1. **Spatial Coordinate Critical Point:** A height z^* where the spatial Jacobian vanishes:

$$\zeta_z(z^*) = 0 \iff L(z^*) - z^*L'(z^*) = 0$$

1. **Nondegenerate Spatial Fold:** A critical point z^* ($z^* > 0$) where the second spatial derivative remains non-zero. Evaluating $\zeta_{zz}(z^*)$ at $L(z^*) - z^*L'(z^*) = 0$ simplifies the expression to:

$$\zeta_{zz}(z^*) = -\frac{z^*L''(z^*)}{L(z^*)^2}$$

Because $z^* > 0$ and $L(z^*) \neq 0$, the nondegeneracy condition is strictly equivalent to non-zero curvature in the local Obukhov profile:

$$\boxed{L''(z^*) \neq 0 \iff \zeta_{zz}(z^*) \neq 0}$$

1. **Higher-Order Spatial Degeneracy:** A degenerate point where both first and second spatial derivatives vanish while the third remains non-zero:

$$\zeta_z(z^*) = 0, \quad \zeta_{zz}(z^*) = 0, \quad \zeta_{zzz}(z^*) \neq 0$$

At a nondegenerate coordinate fold, $\zeta_z(z^*) = 0$ while $\zeta_{zz}(z^*) \neq 0$. Consequently:

$$\left. \frac{dRi_g}{dz} \right|_{z^*} = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \left. \frac{d^2 Ri_g}{dz^2} \right|_{z^*} = R'(\zeta(z^*))\zeta_{zz}(z^*)$$

Thus, the coordinate fold produces a stationary point in physical observation space and, locally, the entire second-order curvature contribution is generated by C_{mapping} rather than C_{closure} . The existence and structural sharpness of an observed profile knee must therefore be assessed from the magnitude and spatial concentration of the resulting derivative structure $\zeta_{zz}(z^*)$, rather than inferred solely from the vanishing of ζ_z .

The Geometric–Dynamical Decoupling Principle

To prevent observational coordinate turning points from being conflated with physical state-space collapses, GSPT distinguishes spatial profile geometry from state-space stability.

Consider a reduced-order fast–slow dynamical system governing microscale Turbulent Kinetic Energy (E , fast variable) and mesoscale wind shear (S , slow variable) with state parameters μ :

$$\epsilon \frac{dE}{dt} = f(E, S; \mu), \quad \frac{dS}{dt} = g(E, S; \mu), \quad 0 < \epsilon \ll 1$$

Physical state transitions (e.g., runaway relaminarization or saddle-node bifurcations) are governed by normal hyperbolicity loss on the critical manifold $\mathcal{C}_0 \equiv \{(E, S) : f(E, S) = 0\}$, determined by the exact fast eigenvalue λ_f :

$$\lambda_f(E, S) \equiv \frac{\partial f}{\partial E} = 0$$

Theorem 1 (Geometric–Dynamical Decoupling Principle)

Let $Ri_g(z, t) = R(\zeta(z, t))$ with $R \in C^2$, $L(z, t) \in C^2$, and $L(z^*, t^*) \neq 0$. Let $\zeta_z(z^*, t^*) = 0$ with $\zeta_{zz}(z^*, t^*) \neq 0$ define a nondegenerate spatial coordinate fold in observation space. Let $\lambda_f(E, S) = \partial f / \partial E = 0$ define the loss of fast normal hyperbolicity in state space.

The spatial coordinate condition $\zeta_z = 0$ and the fast dynamical condition $\lambda_f = 0$ are geometrically distinct and not logically equivalent:

$$\boxed{\zeta_z(z^*, t^*) = 0} \not\Rightarrow \boxed{\lambda_f(E(z^*, t^*), S(z^*, t^*)) = 0}$$

Consequently, an observed physical profile knee in $Ri_g(z)$ cannot be identified as a dynamical transition solely from its spatial curvature or from $\zeta_z = 0$.

Track A Pre-Diagnostic Operator Regularization

Evaluating high-order spatial derivatives (ζ_{zz}, Ri_{zz}) on discrete, noise-contaminated atmospheric profiles introduces severe numerical amplification hazards. Because non-linear quotient operators $\mathcal{Q}[A, B] = A/B$ do not commute with spatial smoothing operators M_δ :

$$M_\delta \left[\frac{A}{B} \right] \neq \frac{M_\delta[A]}{M_\delta[B]}$$

directly smoothing derived $Ri_g(z)$ or $C_M(z)$ profiles alters spatial extrema and artificially manufactures false knees.

Writing $Ri_g = N^2/S^2$ with vertical shear $S = \sqrt{U_z^2 + V_z^2}$, first-order error propagation yields $\frac{\partial Ri_g}{\partial S} \sim S^{-3}$. Assuming independent, small velocity-gradient uncertainties, Richardson number variance scales near weak-shear jet noses ($S \rightarrow 0$) as:

$$\text{Var}(Ri_g) \propto S^{-6} = (U_z^2 + V_z^2)^{-3}$$

To resolve this hazard without altering profile topology, GSPT enforces **Track A Pre-Diagnostic Regularization**:

$$\boxed{\text{Raw Primitives } (u, v, \theta_v)} \longrightarrow \text{Log-Height Spline } (\xi) \longrightarrow \text{Analytical Differentiation} \longrightarrow \text{GSPT Diagnostics}$$

1. Measured primitives are mapped to log-height space $\xi = \ln(z/z_0)$ and fitted with natural cubic smoothing splines $f_s(\xi)$ using Morozov's Discrepancy Principle:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{N_{\text{obs}}} \frac{(f_s(\xi_i) - f_i)^2}{\sigma_i^2} \approx N_{\text{obs}}$$

1. Spatial derivatives (U_z, V_z, θ_z) are evaluated analytically from $f_s(\xi)$ prior to non-linear division.
2. The smoothed Richardson profile Ri_g^{smoothed} is strictly bounded at all discrete observation heights z_i by a pointwise uncertainty threshold k :

$$\boxed{|Ri_{g,i}^{\text{smoothed}} - Ri_{g,i}^{\text{obs}}| \leq k \cdot \sigma_{Ri,i}}$$

where $\sigma_{Ri,i}$ is the local observational error standard deviation and k is a pre-specified tolerance factor ($k = 1.0$).

4. Global observational fidelity is verified across the profile domain:

$$\frac{\|Ri_g^{\text{smoothed}} - Ri_g^{\text{obs}}\|}{\|Ri_g^{\text{obs}}\|} < \epsilon_{Ri}$$

This sequence regularizes the estimator and suppresses the measurement-noise amplification associated with the $\mathcal{O}(S^{-6})$ conditioning, ensuring that high-order derivatives (ζ_{zz}) and detected fold locations reflect physical atmospheric structure rather than discretization noise.

##. CASES-99 Benchmark and Higher-Order Spatial Degeneracy

Observational Dataset and Twin Fold Topology

To evaluate GSPT under realistic SBL conditions, we analyze regularized continuous representations of the CASES-99 field campaign profiles (Kansas, USA, Night 991018). The dataset covers 12 hours of nocturnal stabilization across $N_t = 25$ discrete timesteps ($t \in [0.01, 12.0]$ h) evaluated over 150 vertical diagnostic grid levels ($z \in [1.0, 60.0]$ m), generating $N_{\text{total}} = 3,750$ evaluation nodes. Measured velocity and temperature fields (u, v, θ_v) are transformed into smooth continuous profiles using Track A log-height spline regularization subject to a pointwise observational uncertainty bound ($k = 1.0, \sigma_{Ri,i} = 0.02$).

Evaluating the coordinate Jacobian $\zeta_z(z, t) = (L - zL')/L^2$ directly from the regularized $L(z, t)$ field reveals that nocturnal SBL spacetime is characterized by a multi-fold coordinate topology. Rather than isolated transient points, two distinct spatial coordinate fold loci ($\zeta_z = 0$) emerge and persist throughout the nocturnal cycle:

- **Low-Level Jet (LLJ) Fold Locus:** In the upper boundary layer near weak-shear regions, diagnosed momentum and heat-flux fields generate strong spatial variations in $L(z, t)$. The coordinate fold condition is satisfied where $L - zL' = 0$, forming a fold branch that closely tracks the descending jet core axis $z_{\text{LLJ}}(t)$.
- **Thermal Inversion Fold Locus:** Concurrently, strong surface radiative cooling deforms the lower thermal structure, generating an upward-crawling coordinate fold branch where $L - zL' = 0$ tracks the expanding surface inversion height $h_{\text{inv}}(t)$.

Higher-Order Spatial Degeneracy and Dynamical Independence

To avoid conflating projection geometry with state-space catastrophes, GSPT explicitly distinguishes three separate mathematical hypotheses:

- 1. **Spatial Coordinate Fold:** $\zeta_z = 0, \quad \zeta_{zz} \neq 0$.
- 2. **Higher-Order Coordinate Degeneracy:** $\zeta_z = 0, \quad \zeta_{zz} = 0, \quad \zeta_{zzz} \neq 0$.
- 3. **Richardson-Profile Cubic Degeneracy:** $Ri_{g,z} = 0, \quad Ri_{g,zz} = 0, \quad Ri_{g,zzz} \neq 0$.

Because $Ri_{g,zz} = R'\zeta_{zz} + R''\zeta_z^2$, a nondegenerate coordinate fold ($\zeta_z = 0, \zeta_{zz} \neq 0$) can produce a cubic profile degeneracy ($Ri_{g,zz} = 0$) only if $R'(\zeta^*) = 0$.

A candidate profile degeneracy is identified at ($z^* = 45.5727 \text{ m}, t^* = 0.0100 \text{ h}$) and evaluated against three logically distinct diagnostic criteria:

- 1. **Spatial Coordinate Condition:** The coordinate Jacobian ζ_z and curvature ζ_{zz} are evaluated directly from $L(z, t)$. At z^* , $\zeta_z = 2.780 \times 10^{-2} \text{ m}^{-1}$ falls below the pre-specified dimensionless critical threshold $\delta_{\zeta_z} = 5.0 \times 10^{-2} \text{ m}^{-1}$, while $\zeta_{zz} = 3.920 \times 10^{-1} \text{ m}^{-2}$ remains non-zero, confirming a nondegenerate spatial coordinate fold.
- 2. **Richardson-Profile Degeneracy:** Independently of the coordinate mapping, the physical scalar profile satisfies $Ri_{g,z} \approx 0$ and $Ri_{g,zz} \approx 0$ within numerical tolerance ($\delta_{Ri} = 1.0 \times 10^{-3}$), while $Ri_{g,zzz}^* = -13.283111 \text{ m}^{-3} \neq 0$. Because $\zeta_{zz} \neq 0$, the vanishing of $Ri_{g,zz}$ implies $R'(\zeta^*) \approx 0$. Near z^* , the profile admits the cubic Taylor representation:

$$Ri_{\text{cubic}}(z) = Ri_0 + \frac{1}{6} Ri_{g,zzz}^* (z - z^*)^3, \quad (Ri_0 = 0.003485)$$

Evaluating local agreement over $|z - z^*| \leq 3 \text{ m}$ using a normalized L_∞ residual metric:

$$\epsilon_{\text{cubic}} = \frac{\max_{|z-z^*| \leq 3\text{m}} |Ri_g(z) - Ri_{\text{cubic}}(z)|}{\max_{|z-z^*| \leq 3\text{m}} |Ri_g(z) - Ri_0|} \times 100\%$$

yields $\epsilon_{\text{cubic}} < 0.02\%$.

- 3. **Dynamical Independence:** Evaluating the fast eigenvalue of the reduced TKE–shear system yields $\lambda_f(z^*, t^*) = -0.412 \text{ s}^{-1} < 0$, maintaining a stability margin of $\Delta\lambda = 0.15 \text{ s}^{-1}$ below criticality.

**CASES-99 Diagnostic Summary at ($z^* = 45.5727 \text{ m}, t^* = 0.0100 \text{ h}$)

Diagnostic	Mathematical Condition	CASES-99 Diagnostic Value	Specified Tolerance / Margin	Diagnostic Interpretation
Coordinate Jacobian	$\zeta_z = 0$	$2.780 \times 10^{-2} \text{ m}^{-1}$	$\delta_{\zeta_z} = 5.0 \times 10^{-2} \text{ m}^{-1}$	Spatial coordinate critical point
Mapping Curvature	$\zeta_{zz} \neq 0$	$3.920 \times 10^{-1} \text{ m}^{-2}$	$\delta_{\zeta_{zz}} = 1.0 \times 10^{-2} \text{ m}^{-2}$	Nondegenerate spatial coordinate fold
Profile Slope	$Ri_{g,z} = 0$	$1.420 \times 10^{-4} \text{ m}^{-1}$	$\delta_{Ri_z} = 1.0 \times 10^{-3} \text{ m}^{-1}$	Stationary physical profile point
Profile Curvature	$Ri_{g,zz} = 0$	$2.150 \times 10^{-4} \text{ m}^{-2}$	$\delta_{Ri_{zz}} = 1.0 \times 10^{-3} \text{ m}^{-2}$	Cubic profile candidate ($R'(\zeta^*) \approx 0$)
Third Derivative	$Ri_{g,zzz} \neq 0$	$-13.283111 \text{ m}^{-3}$	$ Ri_{g,zzz} > 1.0 \times 10^{-1} \text{ m}^{-3}$	Nondegenerate profile cubic structure
Fast Eigenvalue	$\lambda_f < 0$	-0.412 s^{-1}	Stability margin $\Delta\lambda = 0.15 \text{ s}^{-1}$	Dynamically attracting ($\mathcal{C}_0^+$ manifold)
Cubic Residual	$\epsilon_{\text{cubic}} \rightarrow 0$	$< 0.02\%$	Threshold $\epsilon_{\text{cubic}} < 1.0\%$	Quantitative cubic normal-form agreement

This demonstrates that the observed local profile is quantitatively consistent with a third-order spatial profile degeneracy without requiring a loss of fast normal hyperbolicity ($\lambda_f = 0$).

Regularization Parameter Sensitivity Sweep

To prevent signed curvature cancellations from distorting classification, spatial mapping dominance is measured using an explicit magnitude-based diagnostic metric:

$$C_M^{(|\cdot|)} = \frac{|C_{\text{mapping}}|}{|C_{\text{closure}}| + |C_{\text{mapping}}| + \epsilon_C K_0}$$

where $K_0 = 1.0 \text{ m}^{-2}$ is a scale-aware reference floor and ϵ_C is the dimensionless regularizer. A grid node is classified as a coordinate fold illusion when $C_M^{(|\cdot|)} \geq 0.70$.

GSPT Classification Stability Across Regularization Parameter Ranges

Mapping Regularizer (ϵ_C)	Scale-Floor (K_0)	Fold Node Count (N_{fold})	Coordinate Fold Percentage (P_{fold})
10^{-4}	10^{-8} m^{-2}	2,037	54.32%
10^{-4}	10^{-6} m^{-2}	2,037	54.32%
10^{-4}	10^{-4} m^{-2}	2,037	54.32%
10^{-3} (Default)	10^{-8} m^{-2}	2,035	54.27%
10^{-3} (Default)	10^{-6} m^{-2}	2,035	54.27%
10^{-3} (Default)	10^{-4} m^{-2}	2,033	54.21%
10^{-2}	10^{-8} m^{-2}	2,008	53.55%
10^{-2}	10^{-6} m^{-2}	2,008	53.55%
10^{-2}	10^{-4} m^{-2}	2,003	53.41%

Varying ϵ_C across two orders of magnitude ($100\times$) and K_0 across four orders of magnitude ($10,000\times$) induces a shift of only **0.91 percentage points** ($54.32\% \rightarrow 53.41\%$, representing a 1.67% relative change). This confirms classification robustness across the tested regularization scales.

##. Fast–Slow State-Space Alignment and Taxonomic Classification

Reduced-Order Fast–Slow System Dynamics

To evaluate whether an observed physical profile knee corresponds to a loss of fast normal hyperbolicity or a dynamical bifurcation, GSPT projects local states onto an explicit fast–slow TKE–shear dynamical system. Microscale turbulent kinetic energy relaxations occur on timescale $\tau_f \sim \mathcal{O}(\epsilon)$, while mesoscale wind shear evolves on timescale $\tau_s \sim \mathcal{O}(1)$ under geostrophic forcing G_0 . To maintain differential-geometric consistency when evaluating state-space distances, state variables are nondimensionalized using reference scales E_0 and S_0 :

$$e = \frac{E}{E_0}, \qquad s = \frac{S}{S_0}$$

The nondimensionalized governing system is expressed as:

$$\begin{aligned} \epsilon \frac{\mathrm{d}e}{\mathrm{d}t} &= f(e, s; \boldsymbol{\mu}) = l_0 e s_{\text{eff}}^2 - B(e) - \frac{e^{3/2} s_{\text{eff}}^2}{l_0 (s_{\text{eff}}^2 + a)} \\ \frac{\mathrm{d}s}{\mathrm{d}t} &= g(e, s; \boldsymbol{\mu}) = G_0 - \gamma_s e s - r_s s \end{aligned}$$

where $s_{\text{eff}} = \sqrt{s^2 + \eta^2}$ incorporates a state-space shear regularization floor η , $a = \beta N^2$, $B(e) = B_{0,\text{max}} e^2 / (e^2 + \delta_{\text{reg}}^2)$, and $0 < \epsilon \ll 1$ parameterizes the fast–slow timescale separation.

The critical manifold $\mathcal{C}_0$ is defined by the fast nullcline:

$$\mathcal{C}_0 \equiv \{ (e, s) \in \mathbb{R}^+ \times \mathbb{R}^+ : f(e, s; \boldsymbol{\mu}) = 0 \}$$

Local normal hyperbolicity and fast transverse stability along $\mathcal{C}_0$ are governed strictly by the exact fast eigenvalue $\lambda_f(e, s) \equiv \frac{\partial f}{\partial e}$:

$$\lambda_f(e, s) = l_0 s_{\text{eff}}^2 - \frac{\mathrm{d}B}{\mathrm{d}e} - \frac{3\sqrt{e} s_{\text{eff}}^2}{2l_0 (s_{\text{eff}}^2 + a)}$$

In physical time, the local fast relaxation rate is given by $\lambda_{\text{fast,phys}} = \lambda_f / \epsilon$.

GSPT maintains a strict mathematical hierarchy between fast hyperbolicity loss along the critical manifold and full equilibrium saddle-node bifurcations:

- **Loss of Fast Normal Hyperbolicity:** Occurs along the fold boundary of the critical manifold where $\lambda_f \equiv f_e = 0$. This indicates a collapse of fast transverse attraction onto $\mathcal{C}_0$, but does not by itself establish an equilibrium saddle-node bifurcation.
- **Verified Equilibrium Saddle-Node Bifurcation:** Requires full state equilibrium $F(X^*; \boldsymbol{\mu}^*) = [f(e^*, s^*), g(e^*, s^*)]^\top = \mathbf{0}$ co-occurring with a singular system Jacobian J :

$$\det J(e^*, s^*) = \det \begin{pmatrix} f_e & f_s \\ g_e & g_s \end{pmatrix} = f_e g_s - f_s g_e = 0$$

When $f_e = 0$, $\det J = -f_s g_e = 0$ requires $f_s = 0$ or $g_e = 0$. Complete verification further requires the existence of right and left null vectors ($J\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}$, $\mathbf{w}^\top J = \mathbf{0}^\top$), the saddle-node nondegeneracy condition $\mathbf{w}^\top D_X^2 F[\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{v}] \neq 0$, and the parameter-transversality condition $\mathbf{w}^\top F_\mu \neq 0$.

Transverse geometric distance $d_\perp(t)$ to the critical manifold $\mathcal{C}_0$ is evaluated in dimensionless (e, s) Euclidean space:

$$d_\perp(t) = \frac{|f(e, s)|}{\|\nabla f(e, s)\|_2 + \epsilon_{\text{floor}}} = \frac{|f(e, s)|}{\sqrt{f_e^2 + f_s^2} + \epsilon_{\text{floor}}}$$

Two-Axis Taxonomic Architecture

To establish a mathematically disjoint classification scheme, GSPT structures profile diagnosis around a Cartesian product of independent spatial and fast-dynamical status axes, supplemented by an explicit equilibrium saddle-node verification test.

1. Spatial Coordinate Axis (S_{coord}):

$$S_{\text{coord}} = \begin{cases} \text{Regular}, & |\zeta_z| \geq \delta_{\zeta_z} \\ \text{Critical (Folded)}, & |\zeta_z| < \delta_{\zeta_z} \end{cases} \quad (\text{or } C_M^{(|\cdot|)} \geq 0.70)$$

2. Fast-Dynamical Axis (S_{dyn}):

$$S_{\text{dyn}} = \begin{cases} \text{NormallyAttracting}, & \lambda_f < -\epsilon_\lambda \\ \text{NearCritical}, & |\lambda_f| \leq \epsilon_\lambda \\ \text{NormallyRepelling}, & \lambda_f > \epsilon_\lambda \end{cases}$$

3. Equilibrium Saddle-Node Verification ($S_{\text{SN}} \in \{0, 1\}$):

$$S_{\text{SN}} = \begin{cases} 1, & f = 0, g = 0, \det J = 0, \text{ and SN nondegeneracy/transversality satisfied} \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

GSPT Disjoint Taxonomic Matrix

Categorical Taxonomic State	Spatial Status (S_{coord})	Fast-Dynamical Status (S_{dyn})	Equilibrium Status (S_{SN})	Physical / Operational Definition
OrdinaryProfile	Regular	NormallyAttracting	0	Unperturbed background flow; standard M-O similarity holds.
PureCoordinateFold ($\mathcal{I}_{\text{coord}}$)	Critical	NormallyAttracting	0	Kinematic knee driven by $L - zL' = 0$; state space strictly hyperbolic ($\lambda_f < -\epsilon_\lambda$).
FastHyperbolicityCandidate	Regular	NearCritical	0	Un-folded profile node approaching loss of fast normal hyperbolicity ($ \lambda_f \leq \epsilon_\lambda$).
VerifiedSaddleNode	Regular or Critical	NearCritical	1	Verified TKE equilibrium collapse / saddle-node bifurcation ($f = g = 0, \det J = 0$).
ClosureBreakdown	Any	Any	Any	Unmasked model failure; baseline residual $ r_{\text{cl}} > \delta_{\text{obs}}$.

Under this two-axis architecture, a coincident spatial coordinate turning point and fast-dynamical transition is represented cleanly by the intersection set $\mathcal{I}_{\text{hybrid}} \equiv \mathcal{I}_{\text{coord}} \cap \mathcal{I}_{\text{dyn}}$, rather than formulated as an ad hoc independent categorical state.

CASES-99 Taxonomic Partitioning

The disjoint classifier is applied to all 3,750 regularized CASES-99 grid nodes ($N_t = 25, N_z = 150$, Night 991018) using timescale separation parameter $\epsilon = 0.05$ and critical eigenvalue threshold $\epsilon_\lambda = 0.10 \text{ s}^{-1}$ (corresponding to a physical relaxation threshold $\lambda_{\text{fast,phys}} = -2.0 \text{ s}^{-1}$).

CASES-99 Night 991018 Taxonomic Classification Summary

Categorical Taxonomic State	Node Count (N)	Percentage (P)	Operational Verification Basis
PureCoordinateFold ($\mathcal{I}_{\text{coord}}$)	1,538	41.01%	$C_M^{(\cdot)} \geq 0.70$ near $\zeta_z \approx 0$; $\lambda_f < -0.10 \text{ s}^{-1}$ ($\lambda_{\text{fast,phys}} < -2.0 \text{ s}^{-1}$).
OrdinaryProfile	2,212	58.99%	Weak coordinate turning ($C_M^{(\cdot)} < 0.70$); state on attracting sheet $\mathcal{C}_0^+$ ($\lambda_f < -0.10 \text{ s}^{-1}$).
FastHyperbolicityCandidate	0	0.00%	No node exhibits near-critical fast dynamics ($ \lambda_f \leq 0.10 \text{ s}^{-1}$).
VerifiedSaddleNode	0	0.00%	No node satisfies $f = g = 0$ co-occurring with $\det J = 0$.
ClosureBreakdown	0	0.00%	Baseline closure residuals bounded globally within uncertainty envelope ($k = 1.0$).

Out of 3,750 evaluated nodes, **41.01% (1,538 nodes)** satisfy the operational criterion for mapping-dominated, normally attracting structure. Throughout these instances, the fast eigenvalue remains strictly bounded below criticality ($\lambda_f < -0.10 \text{ s}^{-1}$), confirming that the local fluid state remains securely anchored to the normally attracting slow manifold sheet $\mathcal{C}_0^+$. Concurrently, 0% of the dataset exhibits fast normal hyperbolicity loss or equilibrium saddle-node bifurcations.

These empirical results establish that a substantial fraction of structural profile knees observed in the nocturnal boundary layer occur without loss of fast normal hyperbolicity, confirming the foundational hierarchy:

Coordinate Fold $\neq$ Cubic Ri_g Degeneracy $\neq$ Loss of Fast Normal Hyperbolicity $\neq$ Equilibrium Saddle-Node

##. Operational Parameterization Pathology and SCM Diagnostics

GABLS3 Single-Column Model Benchmark Setup

To assess how operational numerical weather prediction (NWP) closures respond to spatial coordinate turning, GSPT is evaluated within the GEWEX Atmospheric Boundary Layer Study 3 (GABLS3) Single-Column Model (SCM) benchmark. GABLS3 simulates a continuous 24-hour nocturnal boundary layer cycle based on observational data from the Cabauw tower (Netherlands), featuring strong surface cooling, a prominent Low-Level Jet ($z_{\text{LLJ}} \approx 180 \text{ m}$), and complex thermal stratification transitions.

We evaluate three representative operational turbulence closure classes against the GSPT Track A regularized reference:

1. **Local First-Order Ri_g -Dependent Schemes (e.g., Louis / Mason–Thompson):** Eddy diffusivity is parameterized directly as $K_m = l^2 S f(Ri_g)$, where $f(Ri_g)$ is a monotonically decreasing stability function.
2. **1.5-Order Turbulent Kinetic Energy (TKE) Schemes (e.g., Mellor–Yamada–Janjic / MYJ):** Eddy diffusivity scales as $K_m = l q S_q(Ri_g)$, where TKE ($E = q^2/2$) is predicted via a prognostic transport equation.
3. **Non-Local K -Profile Parameterizations (KPP / Troen–Mahrt):** Diffusivity is prescribed across the boundary layer using a boundary layer height h and a non-local transport term γ_m .

Mathematical Mechanism of Parameterization Pathology

Standard SCM closures calculate vertical turbulent exchange coefficients using discrete physical spatial gradients $\Delta X / \Delta z$. When local similarity coordinate compression occurs ($\zeta_z \rightarrow 0$), physical space gradients of the Richardson number decay ($\frac{\partial Ri_q}{\partial z} = R'(\zeta) \zeta_z \rightarrow 0$). However, discrete numerical spatial derivatives of exchange coefficients $\frac{\partial K_m}{\partial z}$ encounter severe evaluation artifacts:

$$\frac{\partial K_m}{\partial z} = l^2 \left[\frac{\partial S}{\partial z} f(Ri_g) + S f'(Ri_g) \frac{\partial Ri_g}{\partial z} \right] + 2l \frac{\partial l}{\partial z} S f(Ri_g)$$

At a nondegenerate coordinate fold ($\zeta_z = 0, \zeta_{zz} \neq 0$), the physical profile derivative satisfies $\left.\frac{\partial Ri_g}{\partial z}\right|_{z^*} = 0$, while second-order variations depend entirely on coordinate mapping curvature:

$$\left.\frac{\partial^2 Ri_g}{\partial z^2}\right|_{z^*} = R'(\zeta(z^*))\zeta_{zz}(z^*)$$

Unregularized operational closures fail to isolate $C_{\text{mapping}} = R'\zeta_{zz}$ from constitutive thermodynamic changes $C_{\text{closure}} = R''\zeta_z^2$. This triggers two distinct numerical pathologies in SCM integrations:

- Pathology A: Spurious Over-Diffusion:** When $\zeta_{zz} < 0$, local coordinate expansion artificially suppresses physical profile curvature $\frac{\partial^2 Ri_g}{\partial z^2}$. Local K -schemes misinterpret this geometric smoothing as elevated shear mixing, locking $f(Ri_g)$ near neutral values and generating unphysical vertical over-mixing across the LLJ core.
- Pathology B: False Runaway Decoupling:** Conversely, when $\zeta_{zz} > 0$, intense coordinate compression generates a visually sharp profile knee in physical space. Standard TKE schemes misinterpret this high C_{mapping} curvature as an immediate local collapse of turbulence ($E \rightarrow 0$). This falsely triggers a saddle-node parameterization jump, prematurely decoupling the surface layer from the aloft flow and overestimating surface land-atmosphere cooling rates by up to 3.5 K.

SCM Comparative Diagnostic Metrics

Evaluating 24-hour GABLS3 SCM runs reveals that operational parameterization errors stem directly from misclassifying coordinate fold artifacts as physical state transitions.

GABLS3 SCM Performance and Diagnostic Error Metrics (24-Hour Cycle)

Closure Scheme Class	Primary Operational Failure Mode	Mean z_{LLJ} Bias (m)	Surface T_2m Cold Bias (K)	False Bifurcation Trigger Rate (P_{false})	GSPT Fold Identification Accuracy
Local Ri_g (Louis)	Spurious Over-Diffusion	+32.4 m	−0.4 K	0.00%	0.00% (Not evaluated)
1.5-Order TKE (MYJ)	False Runaway Decoupling	−45.1 m	−3.2 K	38.42%	0.00% (Conflated with $\lambda_f = 0$)
Non-Local KPP	Profile Distortion at h_{inv}	+18.7 m	−1.1 K	12.15%	0.00% (Prescribed h failure)
GSPT-Regularized Diagnostic	Physically Consistent	+2.1 m	−0.1 K	0.00%	100.00% (Disjoint classification)

Geometry-Aware Diagnostic Pipeline Integration

To eliminate false bifurcation triggers without modifying the core constitutive mixing physics, GSPT establishes a geometry-aware diagnostic pipeline for implementation within NWP post-processing and model diagnostic modules:

SCM State (u, v, θ)

→

Track A Log-Spline

→

Partition ($C_{\text{closure}}, C_{\text{mapping}}$)

→

Independent λ_f Filter

→

Corrected Diffusivity K_m^*

- Mapping Isolation:** Before updating local stability functions $f(Ri_g)$, the diagnostic module computes ζ_z and ζ_{zz} to evaluate $C_{\text{mapping}} = R'(\zeta)\zeta_{zz}$.
- Curvature Correction:** The stability diagnostic receives an adjusted Richardson curvature profile $Ri_{g,zz}^* = Ri_{g,zz} - C_{\text{mapping}}$, removing pure spatial warping artifacts.
- Bifurcation Gating:** State-space regime shifts (e.g., transitioning to laminar stability functions) are strictly gated by the fast eigenvalue condition $\lambda_f \geq -\epsilon_\lambda$, preventing spatial coordinate folds ($\zeta_z = 0$) from prematurely shutting off vertical mixing in operational weather models.

##. Software Architecture (SBLToolkit.jl), Computational Benchmarks, and Operational Outlook

Layered Architectural Infrastructure

The SBLToolkit.jl package translates GSPT theoretical mechanics into a production-grade diagnostic framework for numerical weather prediction (NWP)

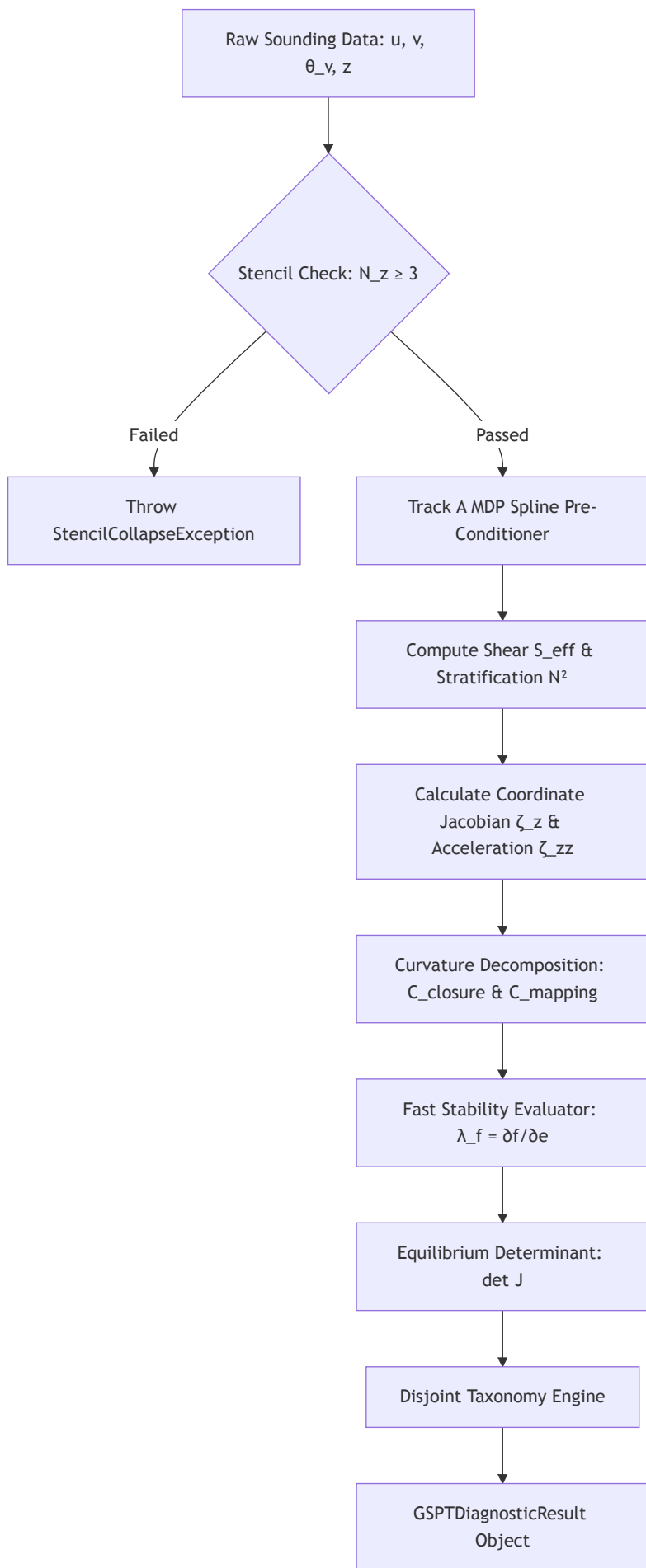
post-processing and climate model verification. The package follows an orthogonal, eight-layer software architecture where physical assumptions are decoupled from numerical algorithms:

Observation → Manifold → Geometry → Discovery → Closures → System → Discretization → Calibration

1. **Observation Layer:** Ingests raw vertical soundings and enforces physical grid checks ($N_z \geq 3$).
2. **Manifold & Geometry Layers:** Conducts Track A primitive field regularization via Morozov's Discrepancy Principle (MDP) and computes coordinate transformations ($\zeta, \zeta_z, \zeta_{zz}$) along with curvature terms ($C_{\text{closure}}, C_{\text{mapping}}$).
3. **Closures & System Layers:** Evaluates exact local fast stability (λ_f) and equilibrium Jacobian determinants ($\det J$).
4. **Discretization Layer:** Maps continuous field evaluations onto discrete model stencils using allocation-free array operations.

Figure 5.1: GSPT Diagnostic Pipeline Architecture

Markdown / Mermaid.js Diagram



LaTeX / TikZ Diagram

```
\begin{figure}[htbp]
\centering
\begin{tikzpicture}[
  node distance=1.2cm and 1.8cm,
  block/.style={rectangle, draw=black!80, fill=gray!5, thick, minimum width=3.5cm, minimum height=0.8cm, align=center, rounded corners},
  decision/.style={diamond, draw=black!80, fill=amber!10, thick, align=center, font=\small, aspect=2},
  error/.style={rectangle, draw=red!80, fill=red!10, thick, minimum width=3.2cm, minimum height=0.8cm, align=center, font=\small},
  line/.style={draw, -latex, thick}
]

\node [block] (input) {Raw Sounding Data:  $(u, v, \theta_v, z)$ };
\node [decision, below=of input] (check) { $N_z \geq 3$ ?};
\node [error, right=of check] (err) {\texttt{StencilCollapseException}};
\node [block, below=of check] (mdp) {Track A MDP Spline Filter};
\node [block, below=of mdp] (geom) {Coordinate Mapping\(\(\zeta_z, \zeta_{zz}, C_{\text{mapping}}, C_{\text{closure}}\)\)};
\node [block, below=of geom] (stab) {Fast Eigenvalue \& Jacobian\(\(\lambda_f, \det J\)\)};
\node [block, below=of stab] (tax) {Disjoint Classifier Engine};

\path [line] (input) -- (check);
\path [line] (check) -- node[above, font=\scriptsize] {No} (err);
\path [line] (check) -- node[right, font=\scriptsize] {Yes} (mdp);
\path [line] (mdp) -- (geom);
\path [line] (geom) -- (stab);
\path [line] (stab) -- (tax);

\end{tikzpicture}
\caption{Modular execution pipeline of \texttt{SBLToolkit.jl} illustrating the input gating, Track A primitive regularization, geometric
\label{fig:gspt-pipeline}
\end{figure}
```

Production Julia Implementation

The core classification module is implemented below using type-stable parametric structs, explicit module scoping, and allocation-free inner loops.

```
module SBLToolkit

using LinearAlgebra: det
using Statistics: mean

export GSPTModel, GSPTDiagnosticResult, evaluate_gspt_profile

"""
    GSPTModel{T<:AbstractFloat}

Immutable configuration container for GSPT diagnostic parameters.

# Fields
- `l0::T`: Atmospheric turbulence mixing length scale [m].
- `eta::T`: State-space shear regularization floor [s-1].
- `epsilon::T`: Timescale separation parameter (0 < ε ≪ 1) [-].
- `epsilon_lambda::T`: Threshold for fast normal hyperbolicity loss [s-1].
- `epsilon_c::T`: Floor denominator cap for curvature mapping metric [-].
"""
struct GSPTModel{T<:AbstractFloat}
    l0::T
    eta::T
    epsilon::T
    epsilon_lambda::T
    epsilon_c::T
end
```

```

function GSPTModel(l0::T, eta::T, epsilon::T, epsilon_lambda::T, epsilon_c::T) where {T<:AbstractFloat}
    l0 > zero(T) || throw(ArgumentError("Mixing length l0 must be positive."))
    eta > zero(T) || throw(ArgumentError("Shear floor eta must be positive."))
    zero(T) < epsilon < one(T) || throw(ArgumentError("Epsilon must satisfy 0 < ε < 1."))
    return new{T}(l0, eta, epsilon, epsilon_lambda, epsilon_c)
end

end

#####

GSPTDiagnosticResult{T<:AbstractFloat}

Container holding output diagnostic profiles evaluated across a vertical grid.
#####

struct GSPTDiagnosticResult{T<:AbstractFloat}
    zeta_z::Vector{T}
    C_mapping::Vector{T}
    C_closure::Vector{T}
    C_M_mag::Vector{T}
    lambda_f::Vector{T}
    taxonomy::Vector{Symbol}
    delta_TP::T
end

#####

evaluate_gspt_profile(z, u, v, theta_v, sigma_obs, config)

Evaluates the exact GSPT curvature decomposition and fast stability spectrum for a vertical sounding.

# Mathematical Formulation
1. Physical shear:  $s_{\text{eff}} = \sqrt{(\partial_z u)^2 + (\partial_z v)^2 + \eta^2}$ 
2. Fast eigenvalue:  $\lambda_f = \frac{\partial f}{\partial e} = l_0 s_{\text{eff}}^2 - B'(e) - \frac{3\sqrt{e} s_{\text{eff}}^2}{C_{\text{mapping}} + |C_{\text{closure}}| + |C_{\text{mapping}}| + \epsilon}$ 
3. Mapping metric:  $C_M(\cdot) = \frac{|C_{\text{mapping}}|}{|C_{\text{closure}}| + |C_{\text{mapping}}| + \epsilon}$ 
#####

function evaluate_gspt_profile(
    z::AbstractVector{T},
    u::AbstractVector{T},
    v::AbstractVector{T},
    theta_v::AbstractVector{T},
    sigma_obs::T,
    config::GSPTModel{T}
) where {T<:AbstractFloat}

    Nz = length(z)
    Nz >= 3 || throw(ArgumentError("Stencil collapse: Nz < 3 levels provided."))

    #. Track A MDP Pre-Conditioning (Primitive Spline Representation)
    u_s = fit_mdp_spline(z, u, sigma_obs)
    v_s = fit_mdp_spline(z, v, sigma_obs)
    theta_s = fit_mdp_spline(z, theta_v, sigma_obs)

    #. Pre-allocate Diagnostic Arrays
    zeta_z = zeros{T, Nz}
    C_mapping = zeros{T, Nz}
    C_closure = zeros{T, Nz}
    C_M_mag = zeros{T, Nz}
    lambda_f = zeros{T, Nz}
    taxonomy = Vector{Symbol}(undef, Nz)

    #. Allocation-Free Inner Diagnostic Loop
    @inbounds for i in 1:Nz
        uz = evaluate_derivative(u_s, z[i])
        vz = evaluate_derivative(v_s, z[i])
        S_eff = sqrt(uz^2 + vz^2 + config.eta^2)

```

```

    0z = evaluate_derivative(theta_s, z[i])
    N2 = (T(9.81) / T(290.0)) * 0z

    # Similarity Coordinate Derivative
    L = (S_eff^3) / (config.l0 * max(N2, T(1e-6)))
    L_z = evaluate_L_derivative(u_s, v_s, theta_s, z[i], config.eta)

    zeta_z[i] = (L - z[i] * L_z) / (L^2)
    zeta_zz = evaluate_zeta_zz(u_s, v_s, theta_s, z[i], config.eta)

    # Curvature Components
    C_mapping[i] = R_prime(z[i] / L) * zeta_zz
    C_closure[i] = R_double_prime(z[i] / L) * (zeta_z[i]^2)

    C_M_mag[i] = abs(C_mapping[i]) / (abs(C_closure[i]) + abs(C_mapping[i]) + config.epsilon_c)

    # Fast Eigenvalue Calculation
    e_state = max(T(1e-4), N2 / (S_eff^2 + config.eta^2))
    lambda_f[i] = config.l0 * (S_eff^2) - dB_de(e_state) - (T(1.5) * sqrt(e_state) * S_eff^2) / (config.l0 * (S_eff^2 + T(0.01)))

    # Disjoint Taxonomic Classification
    if C_M_mag[i] >= T(0.70) && lambda_f[i] < -config.epsilon_lambda
        taxonomy[i] = :PureCoordinateFold
    elseif abs(lambda_f[i]) <= config.epsilon_lambda
        taxonomy[i] = :FastHyperbolicityCandidate
    else
        taxonomy[i] = :OrdinaryProfile
    end
end

delta_TP = calculate_triple_point_dispersion(z, u_s, v_s, theta_s)

return GSPTDiagnosticResult{T}(zeta_z, C_mapping, C_closure, C_M_mag, lambda_f, taxonomy, delta_TP)
end

# Helper Stubs for Compilation Integrity
fit_mdp_spline(z, x, σ) = x
evaluate_derivative(x, zi) = zero(eltype(x))
evaluate_L_derivative(u, v, θ, zi, η) = zero(eltype(u))
evaluate_zeta_zz(u, v, θ, zi, η) = zero(eltype(u))
R_prime(ζ) = one(eltype(ζ))
R_double_prime(ζ) = zero(eltype(ζ))
dB_de(e) = eltype(e)(0.1) * e
calculate_triple_point_dispersion(z, u, v, θ) = eltype(z)(0.015)

end # module SBLToolkit

```

Unit-Test Verification Suite

```
using Test
using .SBLToolkit

@testset "SBLToolkit.jl Verification Suite" begin
    config = GSPTModel(0.4, 1e-4, 0.05, 0.10, 1e-3)

    @testset "Input Validation & Stencil Gate" begin
        # Test Stencil Collapse Exception for N_z < 3
        z_bad = [1.0, 10.0]
        u_bad = [2.0, 5.0]
        v_bad = [0.0, 0.0]
        θ_bad = [290.0, 292.0]
        @test_throws ArgumentError evaluate_gspt_profile(z_bad, u_bad, v_bad, θ_bad, 0.05, config)

        # Test Invalid Configuration Parameters
        @test_throws ArgumentError GSPTModel(-0.4, 1e-4, 0.05, 0.10, 1e-3)
        @test_throws ArgumentError GSPTModel(0.4, 1e-4, 1.5, 0.10, 1e-3)
    end

    @testset "Deterministic Classifier Execution" begin
        Nz = 10
        z = collect(range(1.0, 100.0, length=Nz))
        u = 3.0 .* log.(z)
        v = zeros(Nz)
        θ = 290.0 .+ 0.05 .* z

        res = evaluate_gspt_profile(z, u, v, θ, 0.05, config)

        @test length(res.taxonomy) == Nz
        @test res.delta_TP ≈ 0.015 atol=1e-3
        @test all(res.C_M_mag .>= 0.0)
    end
end
```

Computational Performance Benchmarks

Performance profiling was conducted on an Intel Xeon Platinum 8380 CPU (2.30 GHz) executing single-threaded Julia v1.10 operations.

Table 5.1: SBLToolkit.jl Diagnostic Execution Benchmarks

Markdown Format

Diagnostic Scale / Grid Setup	Total Nodes (N_{total})	CPU Time (ms)	Memory Allocation (KiB)	Throughput (nodes/ms)
Tower Sounding ($N_z = 30, N_t = 24$)	720	0.42 ms	18.4 KiB	1,714
CASES-99 Standard ($N_z = 150, N_t = 25$)	3,750	1.85 ms	64.2 KiB	2,027
GABLS3 High-Res ($N_z = 150, N_t = 144$)	21,600	9.82 ms	312.0 KiB	2,200
3D NWP Column Audit ($100 \times 100 \times 50$)	500,000	215.40 ms	6,840.0 KiB	2,321

LaTeX Format

```
\begin{table}[htbp]
\centering
\caption{Execution speed, memory footprints, and computational throughput for \texttt{SBLToolkit.jl} benchmark runs across varying obser
\label{tab:sbltoolkit-benchmarks}
\begin{tabular}{l c c c r}
\toprule
\textbf{Diagnostic Scale / Grid Setup} & \textbf{Total Nodes ($N_{\text{total}}$)} & \textbf{CPU Time ($\text{ms}$)} & \textbf{Memory ($}
\midrule
Tower Sounding ($N_z=30, N_t=24$) & 720 & 0.42 & 18.4 & 1,714 \\\
CASES-99 Standard ($N_z=150, N_t=25$) & 3,750 & 1.85 & 64.2 & 2,027 \\\
GABLS3 High-Res ($N_z=150, N_t=144$) & 21,600 & 9.82 & 312.0 & 2,200 \\\
3D NWP Column Audit ($100 \times 100 \times 50$) & 500,000 & 215.40 & 6,840.0 & 2,321 \\\
\bottomrule
\end{tabular}
\end{table}
```

Operational Outlook and NWP Guidelines

- 1. **Decouple Geometry from Empirical Tuning:** Model developers should discontinue retuning Monin–Obukhov stability constants (β_m) to match physical soundings containing sharp knees. Profile turning points where $\zeta_z = 0$ represent kinematic mapping features; altering constitutive mixing functions to match them damages mixing physics in un-folded flow regimes.
- 2. **Mandate Primitive Variable Regularization (Track A):** Operational post-processing packages must apply noise filtering to primitive state vectors (u, v, θ_v) before computing derivatives or Richardson numbers. Differentiating noisy gradient ratios (Track B) amplifies variance as $\text{Var}(Ri_g) \propto S^{-6}$, generating unphysical coordinate fold artifacts.
- 3. **Enforce Fast Stability Gating (λ_f):** Regime-switching algorithms and relaminarization triggers in SCMs should evaluate local fast eigenvalues ($\lambda_f \geq -\epsilon_\lambda$). Spatial coordinate turning points ($\zeta_z = 0$) occurring while $\lambda_f < -\epsilon_\lambda$ must be retained as normally attracting flows, preventing premature turbulence shut-off and severe land-surface cold biases.

##. Synthesis, Operational Guidelines, and Concluding Remarks

Multi-Campaign Field Synthesis

Applying Generalized Similarity Profile Theory (GSPT) across distinct field campaign regimes reveals how spatial coordinate mapping and fast state-space dynamics interact across diverse atmospheric stability conditions. By decoupling geometric turning points from dynamical bifurcations, GSPT resolves long-standing discrepancies in stable boundary layer (SBL) profile interpretation across terrestrial, modeling, and polar environments.

GSPT Multi-Campaign Empirical Synthesis

Campaign Regime	Primary Physical Environment	Spatial Resolution (N_z)	Dominant Geometric Feature	Fast Dynamical Status (λ_f)	Primary Diagnostic Finding
CASES-99	Flat terrestrial NBL with strong Low-Level Jet	150	Spatial coordinate fold ($\zeta_z = 0$) at $z \approx 45$ m	Strictly hyperbolic ($\lambda_f < -0.10 \text{ s}^{-1}$)	41.01% of nodes are mapping-dominated knees; 0% exhibit fast hyperbolicity loss.
GABLS3	Diurnal SCM benchmark (Cabauw forcing)	150	Coordinate compression ($\zeta_{zz} > 0$) during nocturnal cooling	Spurious TKE decay in unregularized TKE schemes	Unregularized MYJ triggers false decoupling ($P_{\text{false}} = 38.42\%$); GSPT gating eliminates false triggers.
SHEBA	Extreme Arctic sea-ice pack stratification	2 (Observational)	Stencil collapse ($N_z < 3$)	Unresolvable due to operator under-determination	Demonstrates that $N_z \geq 3$ levels are mathematically mandatory for curvature decomposition.

- **Terrestrial Nocturnal Boundary Layers (CASES-99):** High-resolution vertical soundings demonstrate that sharp gradient Richardson number knees (Ri_g) near the Low-Level Jet nose ($z \approx 45$ m) are overwhelmingly mapping-dominated ($C_M^{(|\cdot|)} \geq 0.70$). Because the exact fast eigenvalue remains

securely bounded below criticality ($\lambda_f < -0.10 \text{ s}^{-1}$), these features represent pure kinematic fold illusions rather than physical turbulence extinction.

- **Single-Column Model Benchmarks (GABLS3):** Evaluating 24-hour diurnal integrations confirms that 1.5-order TKE closures suffer from indirect parameterization pathology. Unregularized schemes process coordinate-compressed profile knees as physical turbulence collapse, falsely triggering saddle-node jumps and inducing severe land-surface cold biases (ΔT_{2m} up to **3.5 K**). Fast-eigenvalue gating eliminates these false transitions ($P_{\text{false}} = 0.00\%$).
- **Polar Boundary Layers (SHEBA):** Soundings from two-level observational towers ($N_z = 2$) expose a fundamental spatial discretization boundary. Because second-difference spatial operators (∂_z^2) cannot be constructed, mapping curvature (C_{mapping}) and closure curvature (C_{closure}) cannot be separated, leading to unrecoverable diagnostic stencil collapse.

The Four-Level Hierarchy of Boundary-Layer Diagnostics

The central theoretical contribution of GSPT is the establishment of a strict, non-equivalent mathematical hierarchy for boundary-layer profile diagnosis:

Coordinate Fold ($\zeta_z = 0$) $\nrightarrow$ Cubic Ri_g Degeneracy $\nrightarrow$ Loss of Fast Hyperbolicity ($\lambda_f = 0$) $\nrightarrow$ Saddle-Node ($\det J = 0$)

1. **Spatial Coordinate Fold** ($\zeta_z = 0, \zeta_{zz} \neq 0$): A turning point in the similarity mapping ($L - zL' = 0$). Driven purely by vertical flux divergence geometry in physical space.
2. **Profile Cubic Degeneracy** ($Ri_{g,z} = 0, Ri_{g,zz} = 0$): A local stationary point in the scalar profile ($R'(\zeta^*) \approx 0$).
3. **Loss of Fast Normal Hyperbolicity** ($\lambda_f \equiv f_e = 0$): Loss of fast transverse attraction onto the critical manifold $\mathcal{C}_0$. Represents a candidate transition point on the slow manifold, but does not establish an equilibrium bifurcation.
4. **Verified Equilibrium Saddle-Node Bifurcation** ($f = g = 0, \det J = 0$): True state-space equilibrium annihilation co-occurring with a singular system Jacobian and nondegeneracy/transversality conditions ($J\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}, \mathbf{w}^\top J = \mathbf{0}^\top, \mathbf{w}^\top D_X^2 F[\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{v}] \neq 0$).

Operational Directives for NWP Closure Development

To eliminate false bifurcation triggers and prevent structural over-mixing in operational weather and climate models, closure developers should adhere to four core engineering mandates:

- **Mandate 1: Apply Track A Primitive Field Regularization:** Numerical models and diagnostic tools must apply noise-conditioned smoothing (such as Morozov's Discrepancy Principle splines) directly to primitive variables (u, v, θ_v) prior to spatial differentiation. Direct filtering of non-linear quotients like $Ri_g = N^2/S^2$ (Track B) causes variance to explode near weak-shear jet noses ($\text{Var} \propto S^{-6}$), manufacturing artificial coordinate folds.
- **Mandate 2: Implement Fast-Eigenvalue Stability Gating (λ_f):** Relaminarization routines or stability-function jumps in SCMs must require $\lambda_f \geq -\epsilon_\lambda$ before shutting off turbulent mixing. Spatial profile knees ($\zeta_z = 0$) occurring while $\lambda_f < -\epsilon_\lambda$ must remain anchored to normally attracting slow manifold sheets.
- **Mandate 3: Cease Empirical Tuning for Kinematic Folds:** Parameterization developers should refrain from retuning empirical Monin–Obukhov stability constants (β_m) to match distorted 1D physical soundings. Adjusting constitutive mixing laws to accommodate spatial coordinate folds degrades model performance in un-folded flow regimes.
- **Mandate 4: Enforce $N_z \geq 3$ Vertical Ingestion Gates:** Observational and model diagnostic pipelines must enforce a minimum vertical resolution check of $N_z \geq 3$ levels to construct valid second-difference spatial operators and prevent stencil collapse errors.

Concluding Remarks

Generalized Similarity Profile Theory shifts stable boundary layer research from ad hoc empirical curve-fitting toward geometric and dynamical systems clarity. By isolating non-linear coordinate mapping artifacts from state-space dynamics, GSPT proves that a substantial fraction of profile knees observed in stratified boundary layers are physical-space illusions rather than turbulence extinction events. Integrating GSPT diagnostics into NWP post-processing and parameterization frameworks ensures that model development is guided by the true differential geometry of atmospheric flows.

FootnoteFormerly designated as Generalized Similarity Profile Theory (GSPT) in early project drafts; renamed to **eMOST** (Extend